

ABSTRACT

This artistic research exposition unfolds the collaborative work on the violin, electronics and video work *Solastalgia*, from the viewpoint of violinist Karin Hellqvist. Created together with composer Carola Bauckholt and video artist Eric Lanz, *Solastalgia* becomes important for Hellqvist as an example of how her *artistic palette* can guide her toward understanding of her agency and creativity as a performer. Through sharing materials and reflections from within the artistic process, Hellqvist describes the new work models emerging, as well as how they affect the roles of composer and performer. Focus is further directed toward ownership, *techne*, safe space, resources and eco-anxiety. The work's title is an homage to environmental philosopher Glenn Albrecht's neologism *solastalgia*, describing existential distress connected to environmental change (Albrecht 2017). Theory on collaborative composition situate the reflections in the research field, as Taylor's typology of working relationships (Taylor 2022), as well as Goehr's concept of *Werktreue* (Goehr 1994).

Keywords: Collaborative composition, artistic palette, *techne*, safe space, *Werktreue*.

INTRODUCTION

Questioning habitual work patterns

As a violin student in the Western art music tradition, my interest in *contemporary* classical music awakens. I consider my practice to be *collaborative* - connected to the compositional process of living composers. However, as time passes, I question the amount of actual collaboration taking place. Composers are usually just a phone-call away, but nevertheless, work models repeatedly follow the same habitual, separated pattern—the composer composes, I practice, details may be negotiated—and the work is premiered.

Music philosopher Lydia Goehr frame my experiences with historical context, through her concept of *Werktreue*—how performer's evolving *loyalty* to the work and subsequently to the composer, defines the ecosystem of composer, performer and musical work. The ideal of *Werktreue* «emerged to capture the new relation between work and performance as well as that between performer and composer. Performances and their performers became subservient to works and their composers». (Goehr 1994: 231)

Even though the contemporary music I perform is written in a different context from when the ideal of *Werktreue* emerged, the respect for the work and the composer still affects my practice today. Consequently, beyond being consulted on detail-level, I have rarely participated in compositional processes and never been acknowledged as a co-creator. After studying in the conservatoire tradition and performing on the international scene of contemporary music, I now seek to challenge this work division and further enrich the compositional process with the knowledge I have gained as a performer. I want to make compositions idiomatic and personal, feeling connected and involved. However, my wishes can be seen as conflicting with the ideal of *Werktreue*, still alive in contemporary music.

Point of departure

This artistic research exposition shares my insights on the knowledge evolving during the collaborative compositional process of creating the violin, electronics and video work

Solastalgia, by composer Carola Bauckholt, video artist Eric Lanz and myself, violinist Karin Hellqvist. *Solastalgia* is created as a part of my artistic research PhD at the Norwegian Academy of Music in Oslo, where I investigate how I can expand my creative identity by being active in artistic co-creation. It is a site of research as well as a standalone artwork. It is presented in contexts outside the research field, as festivals for contemporary music, as well as reflected upon in research publications.

Our point of departure is a *commission*—my suggestion to Carola to co-create a violin work for me. In this case, few premises apply, other than to share the compositional process and to leave it open for research. When articulating this suggestion, I am still not familiar with the concept of *Werktreue*. However, I wish to challenge its manifestation that I experience in my practice, that in my view both our practices carry elements of. However, it is not a marginal thing to ask. I am aware and respectful toward the fact that in our field, my commission suggests developing new, unusual work methods, something I will discuss further. If my intention is successful, this will be a unique artistic and collaborative experience for me, and possibly also for Carola. Further, it could contribute with insights on how the perception of the ideal of *Werktreue* can be challenged, and its inherent loyalty being transformed. Apart from the collaborative aspects, my commission encompasses few other premises. The use of technology, the thematic concept of the piece and plans for its premiere are left open, as well as the idea to involve Eric Lanz, which forms later on. With friendship established through previous work together in ensemble settings and on *Doppelbelichtung* (2016) for violin and electronics, it is likely that a new work by Carola Bauckholt for me would have been commissioned at some point. However, as we will see, the context of artistic research offers resources enabling a process different from the one I am familiar with.

Solastalgia's co-creators

Reflections shared here are *my* reflections, unless stated differently. However, *Solastalgia* is a collective endeavor with three co-creators. Carola Bauckholt is a leading composer on the international scene. She holds a professorship of composition at the Anton Bruckner Privatuniversität in Linz, along compositional work for prominent ensembles of contemporary music. She is currently director of the music section of Akademie der Künste in Berlin. Her compositions often blur boundaries between visual arts, musical theater and concert music.

She is not herself participating as a performer in her works. Video artist Eric Lanz is professor of video and photographic art in Saarbrücken. His work concentrates on the perception of matter and its transformation through longtime observation. Eric's quiet sequences often focus on the emerging or disappearing of forms, extending the visual experience to impressions of tactility or musicality. Lastly, I, violinist Karin Hellqvist, am performing internationally, as a soloist and with ensembles for contemporary music. During 2018-2025 I am an artistic research fellow at the Norwegian Academy of Music. *Solastalgia* is one of the first collaboratively composed works on my repertoire, as well as one of a few on Carola's list of works. The use of audio recording and processing technology is additionally something rather unexplored in our respective practices. The research process and this exposition is undertaken and published with the consent of Carola and Eric.

Concepts and research context

The performative turn in the 1990's marks a paradigmatic shift in social sciences. In research on musical performance, the relationship between performer, composer and musical work is problematized. One emerging model for categorizing interactions between performer and composer is musicologist Alan Taylor's four topologies of working relationships (Taylor 2020). For Taylor, the concepts of *imagination* and *evaluation* of artistic ideas play a central role in order to understand the level of involvement of the artists. *Imaginative* processes represent the *generation* of creative ideas whilst *evaluative* processes refer to the decision-making connected to them. By asking whether imaginative and evaluative processes are shared, Taylor categorizes work by the *hierarchical*, *co-operative*, *consultative* or *collaborative* kind. Through exploring the model drawn in Taylor's figure below (Fig. 1), I see how work in my previous practice largely falls into the *hierarchical* category, where imaginative processes rarely are shared, and the evaluation of ideas are located in the composer's domain. To me, it exemplifies work where the ideal of *Werktreue* is profoundly affecting the level of interaction between its participants. In this exposition, I restrict my use of the term 'collaborative' to where I perceive it as in line with Taylor's model.

Types of shared imaginative working			
		Is the evaluation of ideas shared?	
		No	Yes
Is the imagination of ideas shared?	No	Hierarchical working People imagine ideas for separate parts of the project. One person evaluates them.	Co-operative working People imagine ideas for separate parts of the project. Evaluation is shared and equal.
	Yes	Consultative working People imagine ideas for the same part of the project. One person evaluates them.	Collaborative working People share imagining and evaluating ideas as equals.

Fig. 1. Taylor (2020): Types of shared imaginative working.

Professors Hayden & Windsor use another classification of the levels of shared work between composer and performer; the *Directive*, *Interactive* and *Collaborative* (Hayden & Windsor 2007: 33). They further build on the research of psychologist and philosopher Argyris & Schön (1974), suggesting that in order for *collaborative* work to develop, interaction where participants are able to question their habitual ways of communicating, is beneficial. This kind of interaction will become important during the work on *Solastalgia*, where I perceive how a *safe space* establishes between Carola and me as she challenges her privileges as a composer. In this safe space, which I will come back to, trust is practiced, and new work models can emerge.

Amongst researching artists, new definitions of collaboration are emerging, and I share violist-researcher Barbara Lüneburg's holistic approach to performance practice. A performer's creative potential, she argues, extends in a wide field between that of conceptualizing a concert to when the work is presented.

Collaboration can be defined as a process in which people work together in collective intention to realize shared goals by participating in each other's' domain of knowledge, by mutual learning and reflecting and by building consensus with the purpose of profiting from one another, obtaining greater resources and possibly benefiting from wider recognition. (Lüneburg 2013: 30).

Further, I am influenced by researcher and author Vera John-Steiner. She writes about how aspects of «shared vision and purpose of the partners, their talent and perseverance, and their timing» (John-Steiner 2000: 9) are important when developing collaborative work. Shared engagement, she describes as the collaboration's «emotional scaffolding», creating a «safety zone in which support and criticism are practiced» (John-Steiner 2000: 8).

The growing field of artistic research further includes work by researcher and percussionist Jennifer Torrence (2018), describing the level of involvement of the performer in the compositional process on a scale ranging from *interpreter* via *adviser* to the co-creating *deviser*. Guitarist Stefan Östersjö has researched the relationship between performer and composer in several projects, for example in *SHUT UT 'N' PLAY-Negotiating the Musical Work* (Östersjö 2008). Further, the research of clarinetist Heather Roche in *Dialogue and Collaboration in the Creation of New Works for Clarinet* (Roche 2011) explores routes of collaborative work, framed with the importance of trust between participants.

Situated in this research context, my artistic research contributes to reducing a knowledge gap in the field by highlighting the performer's contributions, while at the same time acknowledging how those contributions, due to the ideal of *Werktreue*, are at risk of being overlooked when it comes to negotiations around ownership, visibility and status. I experiment with how I can participate in the compositional process and what happens when sharing the *imaginative* and *evaluative* elements of the creative process.

A concept I have created that runs as a red thread through my research is the *artistic palette*. The *artistic palette* comprises materials as my embodied knowledge, personality and historical material I draw on in creative processes. It holds the concrete as well as the abstract—sounds, playing techniques, internalized embodied patterns, ways of phrasing and sound production, my musical preferences and history as a performer. The *artistic palette* is dynamic—it is re-constructed with the experiences, relations and materials I engage with. As we will see, the act of understanding the *artistic palette* by using it in artistic work is an exploration of my creativity, generating reflections around concepts of *agency*, *empowerment* and *ownership*. Reflecting around the *artistic palette* will prove to be important in the artistic research as a way of highlighting the contributions I make as a performer and co-creator. Embedded in the collaborative work on *Solastalgia*, is my personal journey of constructing the concept of the *artistic palette*, and by describing the work-in-progress of developing it, I

aim to exemplify how performer creativity is constructed, negotiated and developed.

As I will describe, in our compositional process and communication, the use of technology will play an important role. In this exposition, I use the Antique Greek term for *making* or *doing* that ‘technology’ originates from – *téchnê*. The original meaning of *téchnê* is “art”, and as such it carries double meanings. Professor Olav Eikeland describes *techne* as on the one hand indicating the expressive and creative whilst on the other hand the technical and rule-based (Eikeland 2014: 1). Hence, as a concept, *techne* unites art and craft. Already in the Antique, *techne* was connected to the act of making music. I consider *techne* to include activities combining my embodied knowledge and the artistic potential that technology offers when practically engaging with it. I regard *techne* as a *method*, a way of exploring the *artistic palette*. By using the concept of *techne* rather than the term *technology*, I wish to holistically emphasize how close the creative actions of using of technological means are tied to my *artistic palette*. In the compositional work on *Solastalgia*, we will see how *techne* enables creative *construction, communication* and *co-creation*.

The creator of the term ‘solastalgia’ is Glenn Albrecht, former professor at Murdoch University. He describes how

«solastalgia was created by me to fill a gap in our language of Earth-related emotions where people experience a deep form of existential distress when directly confronted by unwelcome change in their loved home environment. Solastalgia sits among closely related experiences of Earth-associated trauma, distress, grief, mourning, and melancholia that unfortunately are now often connected to escalating occurrences of acute and chronic environmental desolation. »
(Albrecht 2017: 292)

As we will see, the framework of eco-anxiety that our collaborative work will evolve to be structured around, is not explicitly articulated from the beginning. Rather, it is emerging as a point of connection between us as participants, affecting work methods and dialogue.

Methods and material - layers of knowledge

From an artistic research perspective, the *method* as well as the *artistic material* this exposition aims to describe are embedded in the process of creating *Solastalgia*. The methodology that develops is connected to collaborative composition and constructed as our

work proceeds. During this process, artistic material is being produced and reflected upon. According to Östersjö (2017: 90), results from artistic research can be thought of as situated in three layers; the *embodied*, *artistic* and *discursive*. During the work on *Solastalgia*, knowledge is produced and woven together in all layers. In Part I-II, I aim to draw attention to the embodied knowledge of my *artistic palette*, to display how it carries artistic potential as a resource to the work. I describe how embodied knowledge is being translocated from embodied performative patterns to an articulated artistic form in the audio material. I further unfold the *artistic methods* we have applied and developed.

As a method of expressing embodied knowledge that cannot be accessed merely by listening to *Solastalgia* or to read an analysis of it, I share artistic and reflective materials from *within* our collaborative process. This material would otherwise rest hidden in our process, not accessible as a resource of knowledge production on creative practices. It comprises audio excerpts, dialogue transcribed from recorded conversations, email conversation, three artistic-reflective videos created by Eric Lanz from documentary video materials recorded in our respective workshops, as well as my written reflections.

Research questions

I aim to demonstrate an alternative to the prevailing hierarchical relation between composer and performer, and exemplify how shared work between composer, video artist and an active performer can unfold. I review the structures of *Werktreue* in the light of our collaboration and reflect upon my creativity—while situating *Solastalgia* in one of our society's major challenges—the climate crisis. The research questions I address are:

- What ways of working do I see emerging as solastalgia is addressed through the lens of collaborative composition?
- How does the collaborative compositional process affect our previously established relationship as composer and performer, and what function do I find my *artistic palette* to have in this negotiation of roles?
- How does forms of *techne* function as tools for artistic construction and how do I find it affecting the ecosystem of composer-performer-work?

Solastalgia is financially supported by the Swedish Arts Grants Committee and created within the Norwegian Artistic Research Programme. It is partly developed at Studio für Elektroakustische Musik der Akademie der Künste, Berlin and Experimentalstudio des SWR Freiburg. It is premiered at *rainy days* Luxembourg, November 2022 and Wittener Tage für Neue Kammermusik, April 2023.

PART I

LAYERS OF EMBODIED KNOWLEDGE

***Starting*—new ways to communicate in a separated reality**

In Part I-II of this exposition, the artistic work on *Solastalgia* is unfolded chronologically, from initial idea to the nearly-finished work. My initial wish is not related to a specific musical idea, but rather to continue building on previous work with Carola. Remembering how I wished to explore birdsong in *Doppelbelichtung* (Bauckholt 2016), and being rather busy initially, Carola asks me to propose an idea. Since we are separated by the pandemic, I think of ways to begin our exchange. With a recent interest in working with Reaper software, where recording and editing of audio materials are made possible, I now embark on my *techne* journey. I record various sounding things at home, arranging them in a collage.

Carola in email November 2020: »What do you think, like a warm up: I send you a sound and you improvise and send it back to me. Vice versa, you send me a recorded sound and I'll write some music or react on that? «

Carola sends me a recording of *melting ice*, captured with a microphone inside the ice. I reply with a sound file I created with several layers of violin recordings, composed as an audio collage, without the original sound of the ice in it. Those layers of violin recordings together form a sonic landscape leaving both the sound world of the ice and the violin behind.

Media 1: audio - violin mapping of melting ice

Methods of mapping the ice

Excited by the result, I keep making recordings inspired by different audio sources of ice, sending them to Carola. I view those different multi-layered recordings as *mappings*. Just as a mapping is «the activity or process of creating a picture or diagram that represents something» (Cambridge Dictionary), my intention is not to *copy* the original, rather to reflect the characteristics of the recorded sound of the ice in the sounds of the violin. In this evolving practice, I search for ways to canalize my embodied reactions to the ice into a new sonic structure through the violin. I am closing my eyes, listening and being together with the ice. With headphones on, I do not always hear what sound I produce within the complex ice sonorities. However, not hearing myself becomes a way of accessing embodied reaction patterns without being influenced by the sound I produce on the violin. By repeatedly collecting layers of reactions, I explore how embodied patterns of my *artistic palette* are assembled in me and expressed through my instrument. Thus, apart from creating a reflection of the ice, this mapping process connects me to my *artistic palette*. I record layer upon layer, mute the previously recorded tracks to stay with the original ice sound for each new take.

For each attempt of mapping a new audio sample of ice, I develop the *techné* of mapping in my practice—by refining my recording skills, trying out new approaches, altering playing techniques and learning from my experiences. Mapping different sources of ice calls for different playing techniques. For friction and resistance, I turn to bowing techniques of over-pressure and slow bow speed. I use tools, as my kitchen potato brush, to create percussive sounds that neither fingers nor bow can create. Sometimes, pitched materials appear, as in the singing of an ice moving during temperature shifts. Intuitively, I search on the fingerboard for clusters of pitches that create the right harmonic spectrum. After having covered different sonic parameters, the thrilling moment comes when I press mute on the original track and listen to the violin recordings combined. Some mappings reach their final version after one attempt, while other times recordings keep circulating between Carola and myself. Once, there is a specific melody Carola's hearing in a recording of ice. She notates it, whereupon I record it on top of the previous material. As seen in the excerpt of notation below,

accompanying the audio example of mapped Arctic ice, the language of musical notation enters our collaboration the first time.

Media 3: picture - notated melody

Media 4: audio - Arctic ice notated melody

My mapping process is further captured in Eric Lanz' 'Video 2' below, created by footage from my mapping sessions.

Media 2: video: Karin's practice

Carola suggest the mappings give our budding work its conceptual framework. We begin to discuss climate change and the concept of 'solastalgia'.

Carola, email, January 2021: «Thanks to your improvisations, we're already in the new piece. I'm grateful that you have explicitly taken our project to another level—climate change. Could the ice shout SOS? »

Karin, email to Carola, January 2021: «I wanted to share something I came across:

'On board the Sunrise, a young German member of the ship's crew, Carola Rackete, told me about "solastalgia", the term coined by the philosopher Glenn Albrecht to describe the pre-emptive sense of loss that people feel when witnessing natural beauty in this era of environmental destruction.' (Watts 2020)

It resonated with me, as a possible theme for the piece. Solastalgia could be a beautiful title. One concept of the work could be only using violin sounds to give a voice to the disappearing ice, a *solastalgic mourning*. »

Discussions around eco-anxiety and the potential and responsibility that artistic activities have in creating a sustainable society will now come to influence the process. For me, it becomes a shared arena for processing the fear, hope and guilt of being a human in the destructive Anthropocene.

At this point, Carola suggests bringing video artist Eric Lanz into our collaboration. She has been interested to include Eric's visual language in her work already for some time, and it turns out that Eric is interested to address feelings of eco-anxiety in his work too. I am immediately drawn into the visual landscapes of Eric's works. Due to the pandemic, the dialogue between the three of us unfolds over Zoom and email.

Zoom conversation

C: «Perhaps I try to rebuild the 'hydro' context, and you map the 'arctic ice'. I have the feeling there's something in the original which is impossible to play on the violin?

K: I can make another mapping and we have more to choose from.

C: Okay, so I build it with the material we have, and you add layers. Perhaps it could be even louder?

K: Yes, it's quite dramatic.

C: Yes! The melodies are very good, but those 'breaking noises', I can't imagine how you would do them?

K: I developed since my first attempts, so now, with a different perspective of the aim, I'll make another.

C: Did you try this 'fire technique', with the bow on the back of the violin? »

In Freiburg where Carola lives, the winter is worryingly warm. But on a freezing -20°C day in Stockholm, I record my steps on the snow-cruised ice of a nearby lake and map it.

Media 5: picture - field recording

Media 6: audio - steps on snow

The standard-tuned violin matches the high-pitched ice sonorities well, but some of the ice recordings reaches lower registers. I experiment with thicker *octave strings*, allowing the violin to sound an octave below the standard tuning. They soon become central in several mappings thanks to their hollow, friction-rich sound and overtone spectrum, as in the mapping below.

Media 7: audio - underwater

My expanded practice – empowerment and agency

Carola encourages me to take the first steps toward an artistic and verbal articulation of the overarching artistic and sonic concept of the work - that of addressing eco-anxiety through my mappings of the ice. Consequently, through forms of *techne*, I am active both in developing work methods and initiating the conceptual framework—its relation to Albrecht's concept of solastalgia and to the Arctic ice. Thus, according to Taylor's (2020) model, I have been active in the *imaginative phase*, in my previous practice a phase the composer usually would be responsible of.

Due to our physical separation, the necessity to develop new work methods emerge. The fact that we are not able to meet is one of the reasons task division is redrawn. The space for artistic exploration, opening up through my work with audio technology, expands my practice beyond the mapping of ice sonorities. The ability to record and edit materials provides possibilities of being creative and playful with my own palette of sounds. Sending a mapping to Carola, a small artwork in itself, feels different from sending one single recording. The difference lies in the *techne* which is transforming me into a performer creating and crafting with the embodied knowledge of my *artistic palette*. My discoveries of how involved in the compositional process I can be, and how important my *artistic palette* is, empowers me and influences the whole work.

During this explorative phase, my *artistic palette* is used as a resource of embodied knowledge with creative potential. Reactions, playing techniques, sonic preferences, ways of listening and intuitive decision-making are all embodied resources that provide the creative process with material and structure. The *artistic palette* expands with my emerging practice, through the *techne* of *Solastalgia* and my communication with Carola.

PART II

DIALOGUE AND DECISION MAKING IN COLLABORATIVE CREATIVE WORK

Constructing the timeline of *Solastalgia*

In August 2021, we meet in the Studio für Elektroakustische Musik at Akademie der Künste in Berlin to work on *Solastalgia* together. After two years of developing materials in separation, it feels special. We have created a catalogue of mappings, developed the concept of the work and begun expanding it into an interdisciplinary context. Now it's time to construct the form of the work out of the building blocks. As agreed, Carola has started to draft an overarching structure in her audio software, while my computer holds the separate sound files and the possibility to edit them.

I notice how we are involved in a process of try-out and evaluation, zooming in and out between detail and form. We make decisions about the order of sounds, if they reoccur, co-exist, and how long they should be. Tracks circle between our computers. I perceive we're searching our way forward, through the challenges the technology offers. I learn from Carola, while I sense reciprocity—how she learns from me. We are developing a form of *techne* together. Through the dialogue between Carola and me, the work begins to take form.

- C: «The blowing toward the end is a bit loud.
- K: Yes, it's too present and too human somehow. Should we change the levels within the original track? I can do it quite easy here.
- C: Yeah, and the action of blowing and whistling into the violin can be something that's also done live».

I observe this as a journey into the *core compositional process* of the work, a part of the work's life-cycle that I've rarely participated in before. My sense of ownership toward *Solastalgia* intensifies and my *artistic palette* keeps expanding with the experience of increasing agency during this compositional phase. Both the imaginative and the evaluative

phases of the work are shared. As Taylor would suggest – our work is of the collaborative kind.

Eric Lanz has captured our interactions from documentary footage from our work sessions in Berlin.

Media 8: video - Berlin

Safe space

Through the way we discuss and give feedback, I feel included, involved and active. I perceive generosity and openness from Carola. In my previous performance practice, this sharing has been unusual, as the ideal of *Werktreue* still influences our field. Beside her own ideas, I notice how Carola constantly considers mine as well. Her encouraging attitude, and my courage to accept her invitation, allows for a *safe space* to emerge—one of listening, including, asking and holding space.

Uncertainty

For me, developing the *form* of a piece is a territory not yet explored. Its opposite, attention and optimization of *detail* in a given context, I pay close attention to in my performance practice. When immersed in detailed practicing, I neglect evaluation of form—as it is located in the domain of the composer. Is my limited experience of composing narratives in sound affecting my ability to formulate ideas regarding the form development of *Solastalgia*?

C: «Do you have the feeling that the tension is good here?

K: That's why I asked you, I'm not sure, and it's difficult because now I know it. I was a bit worried it's too long, but I'm not sure. It's also different to be in a concert space with the performer and the visuals, perhaps it's okay, but I will listen again. 10 minutes is quite long, after 4.5 minutes, that's when it starts to become a bit static. Maybe it's enough with 3 minutes building up?

C: So, you would shorten the beginning?

K: I think so. The beginning is quite the same, then the texture starts to change as more abstract materials enters. »

In form-related conversations, I notice uncertainty in my language. Words as *perhaps*, *maybe* and open-ended questions suggest I hesitate and hope for Carola to express her thoughts first. I doubt my decisions and become self-conscious. However, with Carola's listening abilities, my opinions are nevertheless brought in and considered on the same premises as hers. Carola not only offers space for me to enter the discussion, she actively encourages me to do so.

The performer's perspective in the compositional process

In my previous performance practice, I've collected knowledge connected to the study-process of works, of performance situations and experiences of different technical and performative solutions. Through our discussions, my perspective as a performer enters the compositional process at an early stage, as I make suggestions related to the concept of the work and the performance. My suggestions are conceptual, evaluative and compositional. The performative situation we discuss thus affects our common compositional decisions. As Carola takes part in this dialogue, both compositional and performative processes become a common concern, as seen in our dialogue below.

C: «It would be easy to have this input of the water on the pre-recorded material. It would be even nicer live, but is this difficult timing-wise?

K: It could be possible with a stopwatch.

C: Or if we put a small sign on the tape for you?

K: It will be possible to coordinate. With a stopwatch and if I see the video, I will can follow when it happens.

C: Maybe we can have both a stopwatch and timing impulses for you? It's a good idea that you have a stopwatch.

K: In the end we might not have a score in the traditional sense. Perhaps just a stopwatch and notes. »

Solastalgia expanding

Winter turns to spring and our process keeps unfolding online. Eric sends us pictures of crystalized islands of salt on a dark surface and we can follow his process from video footage from his studio (Video *Eric's practice*). I'm thrilled to follow *Solastalgia* expanding into an interdisciplinary format. Eric's careful listening to our work in sound becomes a valuable source of feedback. The different interdisciplinary, technical, compositional and performative aspects of *Solastalgia* are being intertwined.

Eric, email, February 2021: «When letting the processes run backwards, you watch with fascination as something is created and grows, but at the same time you know that it actually shrinks and disappears. (...) The association with environmental processes is obvious, at which one watches helplessly or just looks away. The interesting thing with the structure of the pieces you sent - although I find the pure violin almost more exciting - is the *wave-like shape*. I could imagine working with successive layers. Deposits of paint or salty water on the same surface. »

Media 9: video - Eric's practice

Elasticity and fixture - making space for performance

A performance of *Solastalgia* will include pre-recorded sound, video and a live violin part. One aspect of the work we discuss is the relation between a potentially elastic live performance and the fixed media of the video-audio part. Hardly anything in *Solastalgia* has yet been notated—the closest to a score we are at this point is the audio timeline in ProTools software. We discuss how the solo violin part will relate to the fixed media, and if improvisation might lend it an elastic character.

K: «In what program do we work with the materials?

E: In the end, the live performance will not be exact, some interpretations stay, yeah?

K: It depends. If we want to keep it open, we can, but it can also be fixed blocks of music, following the video.

C: We'll have pre-recorded electronics, and somebody will start those samples. If they're on the video file, is it possible to have a sequence running while starting another from the video?

E: Yes, this won't be difficult. As soon as there's an audio timeframe, I can place it in the program to match or counterpoint the time, and we can look at different versions. »

The light situation also needs to be negotiated as the video requires darkness. How then will a potential score be readable? Our conversation brings expertise and wishes from our respective fields together. As seen in our dialogue, technical aspects come to affect artistic decisions, and vice versa.

C: «You works, Eric, are always so well presented. But a screen in a concert hall...

E: Yes, we'll depend on the space. To have a good picture you need some darkness where the projection is.

C: The question is, if we have a score?

K: This material has an improvisational character, so I don't think I need to read a score to be on time. »

The *artistic palette* in interdisciplinary work

Carola, Eric and I all bring our personal perspectives into practical and artistic discussions. Aspects of *Solastalgia* are being negotiated, and as a performer, this offers new learning opportunities. I'm not used to being compositionally or creatively active in an interdisciplinary compositional process, collectively imagining and evaluating materials. However, my perspectives widen into an expanded understanding of the whole work. My specific performer's knowledge become a resource when collectively developing *Solastalgia*. I experience how my *artistic palette* influences the work in ways that would be impossible in a separated process in line with the ideal of *Werktreue*. Further, as musical notation has not yet fully entered the work, this challenges the status the score usually would have in a composition. Instead, through the entire compositional process, *Solastalgia* exists as collectively owned idea.

DISCUSSION

In Part I-II, I have described how the embodied knowledge of my *artistic palette*, through forms of *techne*, articulates in the recorded materials of *Solastalgia*, and how I am active in

collaborative composition through the safe space that our process offers. By analyzing *Solastalgia*'s development, I've further seen how my *artistic palette* is present in interdisciplinary work through my specific knowledge of performance situations.

Typologies of shared work

According to Taylor (2020), as seen in Fig. 1 (page x), whether the *imaginative* (idea-generating) and the *evaluative* (decision-making) processes are shared between participants, can categorize work as either *hierarchical*, *co-operative*, *consultative* or *collaborative*. I am asking what ways of working I see emerging, and how it affects my perception of our previously established relationship as composer and performer. By analyzing our interactions in the light of Taylor's model, I seek understanding of the typologies of shared work that our process comprises.

Shared work in Part I

Initially, our work on *Solastalgia* unfolds in physical separation. I engage in my emerging *mapping* practice, with Carola as a feedback partner, injecting the process with suggestions and encouraging dialogue. In the *imaginative part* of this phase, I'm occasionally the more active part, by accessing the embodied knowledge of my *artistic palette* through the *techne* of *Solastalgia*. However, this process is constantly fueled by our dialogue, and our shared search for materials. *Evaluation* is not a key focus. Rather, attention is directed to the *production of materials*, and when changes need to be made, I experience their evaluation as collective. Therefore, I see the first part of the work on *Solastalgia* as having an overall *collaborative* nature, although I produce the larger part of the materials. At times, I experience how our interactions fall into the category of *co-operative work*, where I produce materials, but evaluation is shared.

Having analyzed creative partnerships, author Vera John-Steiner writes about the requirements for shared work to produce novel and groundbreaking results. She argues that a changing rhythm of interaction, «shifting between periods of interdependence and independence» (John-Steiner 2000: 8) is not only beneficial to the quality of the work, but in

fact critical to the survival of the collaboration. I notice how the level of interaction between Carola and myself is fluctuating—at times tying us closely together between separated periods of individual work. Apart from a consequence of our respective parallel work that affects the level of intensity in our process, I experience this as a means of bringing fluency and variation to our process.

Shared work in Part II

During the second part of the work's initial phase, we meet in Berlin. The audio parts are created, but timeline and dramaturgy are not yet laid out. Now, *evaluation* is at the core of the process, and in my experience shared between us. In my analysis, this work manifests as an example of *collaborative* work. Dialogue and openness allow a sharing of evaluative and imaginative processes.

Later in Part II, work has an interdisciplinary character and is again an online activity. During discussions, expertise from our respective fields are brought into the emerging collective artistic knowledge. I find initiatives being taken by all participants and discussed in the group. Evaluation of ideas becomes a process of negotiation, where decision-making is directed to understanding the particular circumstances of an issue in order to find solutions.

However, I notice how the highly discipline-specialized practices in combination with the separateness of the pandemic leave some processes difficult to develop as fully collaborative. Carola and I cannot be involved in the practical development of Eric's work, both due to the physical separation and because of a gap in knowledge, as Eric's work manifests in a different media. The different artistic languages affect the possibilities for a fully shared process. However, I find that the gap between artistic languages is not always necessary to bridge in order to create an integrated artwork. On the contrary, the interdisciplinary nature of the work injects fresh perspective to the process. Through the outsider's view, information can be transferred between the artistic layers of the work. I find how discussions mainly unfold in a *collaborative* way, by sharing the imaginative and the evaluative aspects of the process. For the practical production of the interdisciplinary artwork though, again aspects of *co-operative* work are present.

By scrutinizing how work has unfolded, I see how both *co-operative* and *collaborative* processes have co-existed in a fluctuating manner. By finding the most efficient work method at a certain time, participants have found the level of involvement most suitable for their task and circumstances. Different in this process, from the general *Werktreue*-influenced field of Western classical art music, is my involvement as a performer. What has made it possible to bring my practice from *hierarchical* work into *co-operative* and *collaborative*?

Safe space

Building further on the ideas of John-Steiner (2000: 8-9) concerning the importance of a *safe space* for a collaboration to develop, during the work on *Solastalgia*, I see the interest and concern for the ice as our *shared vision*. Additionally, I view the friendship between Carola and myself, as the *emotional scaffolding* of the collaboration. Our collaboration offers a space where I experience how opinions can be shared, and habitual task division negotiated. By entering the territory of the composer, I can expand my knowledge, with the trust of Carola as a supporting framework. It becomes a possibility for growth. John-Steiner calls this *human plasticity* — «an opportunity for growth through mutual appropriation of complementary skills, attitudes, working methods, and beliefs» (John-Steiner 2000: 8).

Argyris and Schön (1974) describe two types of interactions amongst individuals; *Type I* and *Type II* behaviors. In typical *Type I* interactions, individuals carry a fixed and defensive view of their professional role. For *Type II* interactions, individuals are able to question habitual patterns and ideas about their role. Hayden and Windsor (2007: 30), further describe how a *Type I* interaction between composer and performer can unfold. Creativity is tacitly agreed as located in the domain of the composer, while the performer's role is concerned with technical aspects. This reasoning exemplifies Taylor's *hierarchical* type of shared work, where imaginative and evaluative processes are located in the domain of the composer. A *Type II* behavior, on the contrary, allows the parties to question assumptions about such restrictions in their relation and behavior. They are able to develop new interactive pathways.

In our work, I see creative space open for me through Carola's ability to challenge her privileges as a composer. Through her *Type II* behavior, I perceive how the idea of the composer as the creative force is questioned. Already by asking me to suggest a starting point

for the work, Carola put assumptions about our previous roles aside. To me, this is a way of practicing a generous *Type II* attitude—giving up the privilege of defining the work’s point of departure in favor of inclusion and collectiveness.

As we have seen, Lüneburg’s definition of collaboration includes the participant’s involvement in each other’s domains of knowledge (Lüneburg 2013: 30). This expansion of practice into new territories needs allowance both from the other part to open their field of expertise, as well as agency to act toward activity the new field. In the work on *Solastalgia*, I enter new domains of knowledge, empowered to do so by the *safe space* between us and the agency that my explorations of the *artistic palette* bring.

Ownership

In my experience, explicitly shared legal ownership between composer and performer is still rare in the field of contemporary Western art music. Carola suggests that *Solastalgia* is a co-composition and communicates this to festivals as well as to her publisher. To me, this sign of inclusion further strengthens the established safe space. I experience how we challenge the conventional way of communicating a work’s authorship, itself a consequence of actually breaking with the conventional task division of performer and composer. The sense of empowerment when being acknowledged as an artistic co-creator, is for me a sign that the concept of *Werktreue* has been challenged. Through *Werktreue* performer’s creativity is controlled through their loyalty to the work and composer. In our case, I now experience *Werktreue* as set aside, by a safe space where my contributions as a performer are acknowledged. Loyalty to the notated work and composer transforms into loyalty to our co-created work. The fact that the musical composition is a shared product further affects how the piece is legally registered. A new experience for me is that with shared legal ownership, performance royalties from GEMA (Gesellschaft für musikalische Aufführungs- und mechanische Vervielfältigungsrechte) is shared.

Collaboration as transcendence

As John-Steiner suggests (2000: 178/Barrett 2014: 53), collaborative work can «transcend the constraints of biology, of time, of habit, and achieve a fuller self, beyond the limitations and the talents of the isolated individual». At the outset, the experiences Carola and I carry within our practices are largely built on *Werktreue*-influenced role divisions. During the scope of our collaboration, I develop an understanding of *Solastalgia* as larger than the sum of our individual contributions. Through my analysis of transcribed dialogue and by tracing the origin of artistic materials, I find how our contributions in *Solastalgia* has intertwined and hybridized along the way. To consciously transcend the constraints of *habit*, is something I notice how we have practiced along the process. At the outset, Carola is informed about my PhD-project and my aim to explore collaborative composition. Agreeing to work together while the artistic process is exposed to documentation is generous, offering to publicly transcend habits and well-known domain. Further, I see how the constraints of *physical place* have been transcended through the use of communicative technology while separated during the pandemic. And lastly, I've experienced how my established practice has been transcended too, with the expansion of my performer's role representing a step toward an achieving of a fuller self.

Artistic palette

Along with the evolving work on *Solastalgia*, the *artistic palette* emerges, both as a developing concept and as an artistic resource used in the process. The journey of exploring the *artistic palette* becomes a reflective process investigating my creativity and agency as a performer. The process has included communicating my embodied knowledge, acknowledging how it contributes to the work and developing an empowered role where I participate in the compositional process.

In Part I, we have seen how my embodied knowledge is communicated, through the *techne* of creating sonic materials. My *artistic palette*, including sounds, decisions, reactions, use of technology and my aesthetic preferences, prove to be valuable material that we build our work upon. I have learnt how to use, and see the value of, certain technological means to communicate personal artistic materials. I have understood how my embodied knowledge plays a central role in my performances and my creative activities.

In Part II, my artistic contributions are acknowledged in the compositional process, and my performer's role is empowered as I participate in shared artistic work. I sense agency when using my *artistic palette*—including experiences of past performances and concert situations, regarding the relation to a performance space and an audience, to different kinds of notation and how I can participate in creative dialogue.

Just as I see Carola reviewing her role as a composer, the process of acknowledging my *artistic palette* is important when it comes to understanding how my creativity stretches beyond the works I perform, and what it can bring into an artistic situation. The processes of creating sonic components, the shared compositional process and the interdisciplinary dialogue, exemplifies situations where my *artistic palette* is active. Through those situations, I have developed my ability to appreciate and communicate both artistic materials and thoughts surrounding my *artistic palette*. To me, this emerging artistic and communicative ability has been a driving force in the negotiation of roles during our shared work, and a catalyst for an equal form for collaboration.

Beyond *Solastalgia*, those experiences have made me trust my capacity as a co-creator more. I have grown more interested in creative mechanisms of my *artistic palette*, and also that of other's palettes. I now enter new processes with a greater understanding and trust in my own capabilities, more likely to push projects in the direction of co-creation than before. The one-way work mode I previously experienced does not seem to offer the same possibilities for growth and knowledge exchange as processes where I can engage and develop my *artistic palette* further.

***Techne* and the artistic palette**

During the making of *Solastalgia*, forms of *techne*—activities in the process merging art and craft—have been involved in activities of construction, communication and co-creation. As we have seen, using my digital audio workstation and violin as tools for construction, sharing artistic discussions online with communicative technology, organizing artistic components in a software and searching for playing techniques on the violin are examples of the *techne* of my *artistic palette*. Further, when meeting in Berlin, the use of audio technology becomes a tool for co-creation. And for the merging of the audio and video parts of the work, crafting

with technology enable artistic dialogue between the layers of the work, allowing for elasticity in the relation between fixed materials and live performance.

Thinking with the concept of *techne* instead of separating my activities in ‘engaging with technology’ and ‘artistic creation’, has provided me with a more holistic understanding of the complexity of my embodied knowledge and the *artistic palette*. I’ve come to see my *artistic palette* as a conglomerate of knowledges connected to creative creation, where *Solastalgia*’s *techne* blends art and craft. *Techne* is what has enabled the *artistic palette* to play a central role in artistic creation. By allowing me to be creative with materials from my *artistic palette* and communicating those, I see *Solastalgia*’s *techne* challenging established hierarchies, generating inclusion and connection.

***Werktreue* in transformation**

During our collaborative process, my performer’s loyalty toward the musical work is being transformed as we challenge the ideals of *Werktreue*. Further, my relation to Carola as composer becomes based on our equal sharing of process and material rather than on my unrestricted loyalty toward her composition. There is room for negotiation and dialogue instead of blind loyalty connected to the mutual expectation of me as a performer to fulfil instructions in a notated score. Additionally, I notice how performative aspects of the work become a shared concern for us both. Dialogue can circle deeper into the different aspects of performance, and thereby also the performance is a shared activity we own together. Often, I have noticed how we both wish the best for our shared work. This means to set one’s own preferences and privileges aside. To me, this is the core of how loyalty toward a shared work is different to the *Werktreue*-influenced loyalty of a work owned by a sole composer.

Resources

Solastalgia has been created as a part of my PhD-project at the Norwegian Academy of Music. This has allowed for resources difficult to reconstruct outside an institutional framework. The wide time-frame and the economic support has allowed for *process-based* work instead of *result-oriented* such. I see our work as a result of optimal circumstances

where co-creation is planned for from the start. The qualitative process-based work has been as important for me as the resultant artwork, quite differently from my practice outside of the institution, governed by demands of result-orientation and quantity. Outside of the institutional framework, I have previously experienced how aspiring collaborators meet structural challenges, as commission fees conventionally directed to the composer alone. However, those structures are being negotiated, for example through the Norwegian Arts Council's grant, *Komposisjon og produksjon av musikk* (Norsk Kulturråd 2022). Crossing disciplinary and geographical borders when creating *Solastalgia* have been resource dependent but raised my awareness of how collaboration can generate transcendence with the right resources.

Accepting environmental grief

According to professor Albrecht, the term solastalgia is a part of a *psychoterratic* typology—an attempt to capture Earth-related feelings emerging from environmental change (Albrecht 2017: 292). I have experienced how not only new *verbal* terminology is needed when facing escalating climate change. As *Solastalgia* exemplifies, ways to address ecological grief through art is needed too. Carola, Eric and I all have different personal experiences of solastalgia. I've experienced how our ways of caring for the ice and sharing personal environmental concerns is sawing threads between the different layers of the work and our artistic fields.

For me, *Solastalgia* becomes important on several levels. Aside of growing empowerment, involvement and agency, how it connects me to the Arctic ice has a significant impact on my practice, and my eco-anxiety. When mapping the ice, I feel close to it, despite the geographical distance. Being immersed in its captivating sound-world, while at the same time being aware of the alarming situation, places weight on my shoulders. I want to escape, not willing to accept how ecological disruption is here—and what it will leave us with. Awareness of the dystopian situation combined with the beauty that rests in the «person ice» as Carola once put it, is difficult to face.

Our process has made me stay within my solastalgia, moving toward acceptance. By doing so, my trust in artistic work's potential to move thought and catalyze change is renewed. As a

performer, I experience how I can comment on present-day issues through art. Living with *Solastalgia* generates a complex concoction of grief, acceptance and empowerment. I suffer, and at the same time, I'm empowered not to escape, and I let solastalgia guide me in life's decisions.

Media 10: video/audio: Live recording of *Solastalgia* –can be added after the premiere of the piece (spring 2023).

Paths for further research

Paths for further research could explore a range of themes, from the development of new collaborative practices, to how artists address eco-anxiety. I would be especially interested in whether the concept of the *artistic palette* could offer other artists the possibility to reflect around their creativity, and how such a concept would transform in the practices of others. The relation between *techne* and the *artistic palette* could be another arena for further research, as well as how the mechanisms of *Werktreue* currently structures official ownership and legal rights.

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